

Case Study 1

HES 3000-002: Sport Performance Analytics

Fall 2026

Overview

The goal of this case study is to develop a focused analytical question based on a sport-related observation, concern, or decision and identify possible data sources that could be used to answer it.

This case study is intended to demonstrate how the specificity of a question determines the information needed to answer it. You may find that the ideal data are unavailable, incomplete, or difficult to access. That is not a failure of the exercise. Identifying these limitations is an important part of determining whether an analytical question can realistically be pursued.

Part 1: Develop your Analytical Question

Begin with a sport-related observation, concern, or decision that interests you. Use the principles discussed in class to turn it into a focused analytical question. Your question should be specific enough to investigate and broad enough to produce a meaningful answer.

In your submission, provide:

- Your initial observation, concern, or decision.
- Your analytical question.
- Who would use the answer and what decision it could inform.
- The outcome, comparison, and context included in your question.

Part 2: Identify the Data

Find and download a dataset that could help answer your analytical question. If you are unsure where to start, you may use [this link](https://sportsandsociety.osu.edu/sports-data-sets) as a starting point, but you are not required to use it. (url: sportsandsociety.osu.edu/sports-data-sets)

In your submission, provide:

- The dataset name and a link to its source.
- A brief description of what the dataset contains.
- An explanation of how it relates to your question.
- Based on the available data, would you keep, revise, or abandon your original question? Explain your decision. If you revise the question, provide the revised version.

Submit the dataset along with your response. If you cannot find a suitable dataset, describe where you searched and what information appears to be unavailable.

Grading Rubric

Part 1 (17 points)	
2	Clearly identifies the sport-related starting point.
5	Question is clear, focused, meaningful, and specific enough to investigate without being unnecessarily narrow.
2	Identifies who would use the answer.
2	Explains what decision the answer could inform or why the answer would matter.
2	Clearly identifies what is being examined or evaluated.
2	Establishes a meaningful reference point, group, condition, or period.
2	Defines the relevant context (eg: teams, situation, timeframe).
Part 2: Identify the Dataset (8 points)	
2	Identifies the dataset and provides a working link to its original source.
2	Accurately describes what the dataset contains.
2	Clearly explains how the dataset could help answer the analytical question.
2	States whether the original question should be kept, revised, or abandoned based on the data search and explains why. If revised, provides the revised question.

Note: Grading emphasizes correctness of classification and clarity of explanation. The complexity or size of the dataset is not important.